

HackMoney 2026 Research

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Designed for hackers around the world to build DeFi applications.

HackMoney 2026 Finalists-

Each finalist team member receives 1000 USDC delivered to their verified wallets.

Yellow

Yellow

\$15,000

About

Yellow Network lets you deposit crypto once and make lightning-fast transactions without waiting for blockchain confirmations or paying gas each time. It combines the best of both worlds — the speed of off-chain systems and the security of smart contracts.

Most interactions between parties don't need immediate on-chain settlement. Consider a chess game with a 10 USDC wager:

- On-chain approach: Every move requires a transaction → 40+ transactions → \$100s in fees.
- State channel approach: Lock funds once, play off-chain, settle once → 2 transactions → minimal fees.

State channels let you execute unlimited off-chain operations between on-chain checkpoints.

How it works:

When you send funds or interact with an app, your transfers happen off-chain through a secure network of Yellow nodes that keep balances in sync. It feels instant, like using a regular web2 app. Smart contracts on each blockchain act as safes: they hold your deposit, verify everything, and make sure your money is protected. If you ever stop using the app or want to withdraw, your final balance is settled on-chain. Your session is protected by unique digital keys that only you control. No one can change your balance or take your funds. Even if something goes wrong, your assets automatically return to you.

Key features:

- Works as a Layer-2 network, not a new blockchain.
- Enables real-time, gasless payments that still settle safely on your preferred chain.
- Designed for games, apps, and tools that need instant user actions and smooth UX.
- Includes built-in liquidity pools to make sure there's always capital available for fast transactions.
- Compatible with all EVM chains, Solana and others coming soon.

Prizes

Integrate Yellow SDK: Trading apps/Prediction markets/Marketplaces — \$15,000

1st place \$5,000, 2nd place \$3,000, 3rd place \$2,000, 4th place \$1,000 ×3, 5th place \$500 ×4.

Use the Yellow SDK and Nitrolite protocol to build a mini-app or feature that showcases instant, session-based transactions - all happening off-chain and settling on-chain when needed.

How to participate

- Integrate the Yellow SDK, connect to the Nitrolite test environment and create a wallet session.
- Implement off-chain logic: simulate sending or spending assets instantly between users or in-app actions.
- Show on-chain settlement: finalize balances through smart-contract calls when users end their session.

Example App Ideas

- Trading apps
- Prediction market apps
- Tipping System: users send 0.01 USDC per like, emoji, or message without gas or delay.
- Pay-Per-Use App: charge users per API call, minute, or read action - settle once at the end of session.
- Cross-App Wallet: one balance shared across multiple dApps (browser plugin, Telegram mini-app, etc.).

Why Build on Yellow

- Gas-free & instant: off-chain state channels = Web2 speed, Web3 security.
- Session-based logic: define allowances for in-game or in-app use.
- Multi-chain ready: works with all EVM chains; Solana support coming soon.

Qualification Requirements

Qualification Requirements - to qualify for the Yellow Network Prize, your project must:

- Use the Yellow SDK / Nitrolite protocol in your submission.
- Demonstrate off-chain transaction logic — e.g., instant payments, session-based spending, or settlement finalized via smart contracts.
- Deploy or simulate a working prototype showing how Yellow improves transaction speed, UX, or efficiency.
- Include a 2–3 minute demo video showing your integration and user flow.
- Submit your project under the “Yellow Network” prize track on ETHGlobal and include a repo link.

Judging Criteria

Projects will be evaluated based on:

- Problem & Solution: clarity of the problem addressed and creativity of the solution.
- Yellow SDK Integration: depth and impact of integration with Yellow technology.
- Business Model: clarity and sustainability of the project’s value or revenue model.
- Presentation: ability to communicate the idea clearly and persuasively.
- Team Potential: team’s skill, passion, and commitment to continue post-hackathon.

Links and Resources

1. <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL5Uk-e9pgXVldFAweLLUcZjvaceTlgkKa>
2. <https://yellow.com/apps>
3. <https://docs.yellow.org/docs/learn/>

Uniswap Foundation

Uniswap Foundation

\$10,000

About

Uniswap v4 is an automated market maker protocol designed to be extensible, efficient, and customizable, enabling developers to create new market structures on top of shared, secure liquidity. We're calling on developers to build on Uniswap v4 and explore how liquidity, trading, and financial infrastructure can continue to evolve within decentralized finance, where tokenized value is deployed and exchanged onchain.

Prizes

Uniswap v4 Agentic Finance — \$5,000

1st place \$2,500, 2nd place \$1,500, 3rd place \$1,000

Build on Uniswap v4 to explore agent-driven financial systems. Projects may involve agents that programmatically interact with Uniswap v4 pools for liquidity management, trade execution, routing, coordination, or other behaviors enabled by onchain state. Submissions should emphasize reliability, transparency, and composability over speculative intelligence. The use of Hooks is optional and encouraged where it meaningfully supports the design.

Qualification Requirements

A user interface is not required, but projects must provide clear evidence of functional code. Each team must submit: TxID transactions (testnet and/or mainnet) a GitHub repository, README.md, demo link or setup instructions, and a demo video (max 3 min).

Uniswap v4 Privacy DeFi — \$5,000

1st place \$2,500, 2nd place \$1,500, 3rd place \$1,000

Build on Uniswap v4 to explore privacy-enhancing financial systems in decentralized markets. Projects may introduce mechanisms that improve how information is handled during onchain trading and liquidity provision, such as reducing unnecessary information exposure, improving execution quality, or designing market behavior that is more resilient to adverse selection and extractive dynamics. Submissions should emphasize responsible, transparent system design

that preserves onchain verifiability and protocol integrity. The use of Hooks is optional and encouraged where it meaningfully supports the design.

Qualification Requirements

A user interface is not required, but projects must provide clear evidence of functional code. Each team must submit: TxID transactions (testnet and/or mainnet) a GitHub repository, README.md, demo link or setup instructions, and a demo video (max 3 min).

Links and Resources

1. <https://docs.uniswap.org/contracts/v4/overview>
2. <https://github.com/uniswapfoundation/v4-template>
3. <https://updraft.cyfrin.io/courses/uniswap-v4>
4. <https://docs.openzeppelin.com/uniswap-hooks>

Sui

Sui

\$10,000

About

Sui brings together high performance, strong security, and deep composability to form a DeFi foundation built for real-world scale. We're inviting developers to use these capabilities to create the next generation of DeFi—applications that aren't possible on other platforms.

This hackathon is also an opportunity to begin a longer-term relationship with the Sui ecosystem. We're actively looking for strong builders and teams to continue working with beyond HackMoney, including through our Moonshot Program, which provides ongoing technical, strategic, and financial support to promising DeFi projects. If you're interested in building on Sui beyond a single hackathon, this track is designed to help you get there.

Prizes

Best Overall Project — \$3,000

Awarded to the project that best demonstrates a compelling use of Sui to build a high-quality DeFi application. The Best Overall Project stands out across multiple dimensions, including technical execution, product thinking, and user experience, while showing clear potential to evolve beyond the hackathon.

This prize recognizes teams that not only build something impressive in a week, but also show thoughtful design choices and a strong foundation for continued development within the Sui ecosystem.

Qualification Requirements

To be eligible for the Best Overall Project prize, submissions must:

- Be built on Sui and meaningfully use Sui-specific capabilities.
- Include a working prototype or demo.
- Clearly explain the problem being solved and why Sui is well-suited for it.
- Demonstrate strong execution across at least two areas (e.g. UX, technical design, market insight, or creativity).
- Show potential for continued development beyond the hackathon.

Notable Projects — \$7,000

Up to 7 teams will receive \$1,000

Notable Projects recognize teams that demonstrate standout strength in a specific dimension of their submission. These projects may excel in areas such as user experience, creative DeFi design, technical execution, or novel use of Sui's capabilities.

This prize is designed to highlight high-quality work that shows clear promise, thoughtful craftsmanship, and strong alignment with the Sui ecosystem—even if the project is early or focused on a particular aspect rather than end-to-end polish.

Qualification Requirements

To be eligible for a Notable Project award, submissions must:

- Be built on Sui.
- Include a working prototype or functional demo.
- Clearly articulate the idea and design decisions.
- Demonstrate clear strength in at least one key area (e.g. UX, technical innovation, creativity, or product insight).
- Show potential for continued iteration or expansion beyond the hackathon.

Resources

1. <https://docs.sui.io/guides/developer/getting-started>
2. <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1UFjTckWeGJf0OSGAP1MtMLQpYI6HqDQ7sMdUYziMMjl/edit?tab=t.0#heading=h.f3gh93s5mbve>
3. <https://www.sui.io/defi>
4. <https://docs.sui.io/guides/developer/sui-101/building-ptb>
5. <https://docs.sui.io/standards/deepbook>
6. <https://github.com/MystenLabs/deepbookv3>

Arc

Arc

\$10,000

About

Arc is the purpose-built L1 blockchain from Circle, EVM-compatible, and serves as the Economic OS for the internet — powering the programmable trust layer and transaction engine where capital, humans, and machines coordinate to drive real economic growth. Arc enables builders and issuers worldwide to power the next era of onchain lending, capital markets, FX, and payments - igniting liquidity across currencies and asset classes.

Prizes

Best Chain Abstracted USDC Apps Using Arc as a Liquidity Hub —— \$5,000

1st place \$2,500, 2nd place \$2,500

Build apps that treat multiple chains as one liquidity surface, using Arc to move USDC wherever it's needed. Projects should demonstrate how capital can be sourced, routed, and settled across chains without fragmenting user experience.

What we're looking for:

- Crosschain payments, credit, or treasury systems
- Applications that are not locked to a single chain
- Seamless user experience despite crosschain complexity

Qualification Requirements

CIRCLE TOOLS REQUIRED: Arc, Circle Gateway, USDC, Circle Wallets

Submissions will be evaluated based on the following parameters. Please be clear what bounty you are submitting for as a part of your submission!

- * Functional MVP and diagram: Projects must demonstrate a working frontend and backend plus an architecture diagram.
- * Product feedback - clear and actionable feedback will heavily influence the judgement of your submission
- * Video demonstration + presentation: Succinctly outlining the project's core functions and its effective use of Circle's Developer tools/tech is required, supported by detailed documentation.
- * Link to GitHub/Replit repo

Build Global Payouts and Treasury Systems with USDC on Arc —— \$2,500

Build payout or treasury systems that move USDC globally, automatically, and reliably. Projects should show how onchain infrastructure can support real-world financial operations like payroll, revenue distribution, or fund settlements.

What we're looking for:

- Automated or agent-driven payout logic
- Multi-recipient, multi-chain settlement
- Treasury systems backed by RWAs
- Policy-based or condition-based payouts

Qualification Requirements

CIRCLE TOOLS REQUIRED: Arc, Circle Gateway, Circle Wallets, Bridge Kit

Submissions will be evaluated based on the following parameters. Please be clear what bounty you are submitting for as a part of your submission!

- * Functional MVP and diagram: Projects must demonstrate a working frontend and backend plus an architecture diagram.
- * Product feedback - clear and actionable feedback will heavily influence the judgement of your submission
- * Video demonstration + presentation: Succinctly outlining the project's core functions and its effective use of Circle's Developer tools/tech is required, supported by detailed documentation.
- * Link to GitHub/Replit repo

Best Agentic Commerce App Powered by Real-World Assets on Arc —— \$2,500

Build applications where autonomous agents use real-world assets as productive capital to power onchain commerce. Projects should showcase agents that can make decisions, execute transactions, and manage risk, all settled in USDC.

What we're looking for:

- AI agents that borrow, repay, or rebalance against RWA collateral
- Autonomous spending, payments, or treasury management
- USDC-denominated credit or cash flow backed by RWAs
- Clear agent decision logic tied to oracle or market signals

Qualification Requirements

REQUIRED TOOLS: Arc, USDC, Circle Wallets, Circle Contracts, Stork

Qualification Requirements

Submissions will be evaluated based on the following parameters. Please be clear what bounty you are submitting for as a part of your submission!

- * Functional MVP and diagram: Projects must demonstrate a working frontend and backend plus an architecture diagram.
- * Product feedback - clear and actionable feedback will heavily influence the judgement of your submission
- * Video demonstration + presentation: Succinctly outlining the project's core functions and its effective use of Circle's Developer tools/tech is required, supported by detailed documentation.
- * Link to GitHub/Replit repo

Links and Resources

1. <https://developers.circle.com/gateway>
2. <https://developers.circle.com/wallets>
3. <https://developers.circle.com/bridge-kit>
4. <https://developers.circle.com/contracts>
5. https://docs.stork.network/?_gl=1*_ajrbya*_ga*MTE2MzIzNTE5Ny4xNzY5NjM3MTA3*_ga_NLZGMPEG3X*_czE3Njk2MzcxMDYkbzEkZzEkdDE3Njk2MzcxMTYkajUxJGwwJGgw
6. <https://docs.arc.network/arc/concepts/welcome-to-arc>
7. <https://console.circle.com/signup>
8. <https://faucet.circle.com/>
9. <https://docs.arc.network/arc/tutorials/transfer-usdc-or-eurc>

LI.FI

LI.FI

\$6,000

About

LI.FI is a cross-chain liquidity and execution layer that lets you swap, bridge, and call contracts across many chains through one SDK/API. With a single integration, you can build DeFi experiences where users move from token A on chain X to token B or a position on chain Y in one seamless flow. LI.FI automatically routes across the best DEXs and bridges under the hood. During HackMoney you can use LI.FI to build cross-chain vaults, 'deposit from anywhere' on-ramps into DeFi protocols, rebalancing/arb agents, and wallet or fintech UX that treat liquidity as one unified market instead of fragmented chains.

Prizes

Best Use of LI.FI Composer in DeFi — \$2,500

Awarded to the project that most creatively uses LI.FI Composer to orchestrate multi-step DeFi workflows in a single, user-friendly experience.

Examples Ideas:

Cross-chain deposit into a vault, staged leverage/hedging strategies, or multi-step LP provisioning with a single sign.

Deposit from any chain into a single restaking or yield strategy.

Turn any asset on any EVM chain into a Perps margin position on a specific chain.

Qualification Requirements

Use the LI.FI SDK or APIs for at least one cross-chain action (swap, bridge, or swap+bridge+contract call).

Support at least two EVM chains in the user journey.

Ship a working frontend (web, mobile, or wallet plugin) that a judge can click through.

Each submission must include a Github repository of the project and a video demo going through your project in detail.

Best AI x LI.FI Smart App — \$2,000

Awarded to the most innovative AI-powered agent or smart app that uses LI.FI as its cross-chain execution layer.

Examples:

An on-chain or off-chain agent that uses LI.FI routes to manage positions, rebalance liquidity, or execute cross-chain strategies automatically.

A rebalancing bot that moves liquidity or collateral between chains to maintain target allocations.

An arbitrage or routing agent that uses LI.FI quotes as part of its strategy.

etc

Qualification Requirements

Use LI.FI programmatically (SDK/API or contract calls) to perform cross-chain actions.

Implement a clear strategy loop: monitor state, decide, then act using LI.FI.

Provide either a minimal UI or a clear CLI/script demo with logs.

Your submission must include a video demo and Github URL of the project

Best LI.FI-Powered DeFi Integration — \$1,500

1st place \$1,000, 2nd place \$300, 3rd place \$200

Awarded to the best DeFi product, wallet, or protocol integrations that use LI.FI to unlock cross-chain liquidity or UX. On this prize, you can build or extend any DeFi product that integrates LI.FI as its cross-chain routing and liquidity layer. Focus on solving a concrete user problem (e.g., cross-chain deposits, cross-chain re-collateralization, migrating positions, multi-chain treasury tooling) with a robust, production-ready integration.

Qualification Requirements

Use LI.FI's core API/SDK to power cross-chain swaps/bridges or deposits.

Integrate at least one external DeFi protocol or wallet context (e.g., lending, restaking, LP, on-chain fund).

Emphasis on reliability and UX for DeFi users (handles slippage, errors, gas, etc.)

Submission must include a video demo of the project and a Github URL.

Links and Resources

1. <https://docs.li.fi/>
2. <https://docs.li.fi/introduction/user-flows-and-examples/end-to-end-example>
3. <https://docs.li.fi/api-reference/introduction>
4. <https://docs.li.fi/sdk/overview>

ENS

ENS

\$5,000

About

Decentralized naming for wallets, contracts, agents, websites and more. Replace 0x addresses with human-readable names. Leverage portable profiles, payment settings, and social features with ENS!

Prizes

Integrate ENS — \$3,500

Split evenly between all qualifying projects

Any type of ENS integration is eligible for this pool prize, split evenly among all eligible projects. Get creative!

Qualification Requirements

You need to write some code specifically for ENS, even if it's just a couple wagmi hooks. Simply using Rainbowkit does not count. Your demo must be functional and not contain hard-coded values. Upon submission, your project showcase must have a video recording or link to a live demo (ideally both) and the code needs to be open source and accessible on Github or a similar platform.

Most creative use of ENS for DeFi — \$1,500

ENS is often thought of as simple name <> address mapping, but really its much more flexible! Names can store arbitrary data via text records, decentralized websites via content hash and more.

This prize goes to the most creative application of ENS in DeFi. This could be some sort of swap preferences stored in text records, DEX contracts that are named via ENS, decentralized interfaces or anything else.

Qualification Requirements

It should be obvious how ENS improves your product and is not just implemented as an afterthought. Your demo must be functional and not just include hard-coded values. Upon

submission, your project showcase must have a video recording or link to a live demo (ideally both) and the code needs to be open source and accessible on Github or a similar platform.

Links and Resources

1. <https://docs.ens.domains/web/records>
2. <https://docs.ens.domains/dweb/intro>
3. <https://docs.ens.domains>